Category:

Reversing

Name:

corrupted

Message:

We found a suspicious executable, but it's clearly corrupted and won't run. The file seems to have been tampered. Can you restore the file? The flag is obtained when you execute the restored executable (without any options).

File: corrupted.exe

Instructions:

1. Running corrupted.exe directly results in the error, suggesting that the Portable Executable (PE) header is malformed.
2. Opening the file in HxD (or any hex editor) shows the first bytes:

   ```
   00000000: 00 04 99 01 40 01 B1 A3 00 00 5A 5A……
   ```

   A legitimate PE file must begin with the MS-DOS stub header signature **"MZ"** (4D 5A in hexadecimal) at offset 0x00. Here, ten stray bytes precede 5A 5A, so the magic number is both mis-aligned and incorrect.
3. Remove the first 10 trash bytes(bytes 0x00 – 0x09) and patch byte 0x00 from 5A to 4D to restore the correct DOS stub signature. Save the modified file as **repaired.exe**.
4. With the MZ header restored, the operating system loads the PE correctly. Running repaired.exe in a terminal reveals the flag printed to standard output.



Flag is:

CSG_FLAG{finding_the_magic_now!}